PHIL YOUNG'S ENGLISH SCHOOL

Extreme Jobs, Hobbies & Sports · Guide

TEACHER

Lesson plan, answer keys and scripts for the Advanced TOEFL lesson pack.

i Lesson overview

2H15

ITEM	DETAIL
Level	B2+ / C1
Total time	75 min + 15 min break + 60 min
Topic	Extreme jobs, hobbies and sports: why do some people crave adventure and risk?
Skills	Speaking, vocabulary, listening, grammar, writing
Grammar focus	Speculating about causes and motives: modals of deduction (present and past) and cause language (*stem from, be driven by, which explains why*)
TOEFL tasks practiced	Take an Interview, Complete the Words, academic lecture listening, Build a Sentence, Academic Discussion, Listen and Repeat, Write an Email (homework)

Aims. By the end of the lesson, students can take structured notes on a 4-minute psychology lecture, summarize it in 60 seconds, use 10 topic words with correct collocations, speculate about people's feelings and motives with present and past modals, and write a 100+ word academic discussion post in 10 minutes.

Materials. One student pack per student, the lecture audio (see Audio) or Script A to read aloud, a timer, and phones for optional self-recording.

Prep (10 min). Print one student pack per student, cut up the debate role cards (Worksheet 4), and test the audio on the classroom speakers.

ii Teacher plan

7 STAGES

Seven stages: four before the break (75 min) and three after (60 min). Every stage reuses the lecture content, so vocabulary and ideas recycle across all skills.

#	STAGE	TIME	SKILL	INTERACTION	MATERIAL
1	Interview warm-up	10 min	Speaking	Pairs	Worksheet 1
2	Topic vocabulary	15 min	Vocabulary, reading	Individual, then pairs	Worksheet 2
3	Academic lecture	25 min	Listening, note-taking	Individual, then pairs	Worksheet 3, audio
4	Summary + town council debate	25 min	Speaking	Individual, then groups of 4–6	Worksheet 4
—	Break	15 min	—	—	—
5	Speculating about causes and motives	20 min	Grammar	Pairs	Worksheet 5
6	Academic Discussion post	30 min	Writing	Individual, pairs, whole class	Worksheet 6
7	Listen and Repeat + homework set-up	10 min	Pronunciation, writing	Whole class	Script C, Worksheet 7

Block 1 (75 min)

Stage 1 — Interview warm-up (10 min)

1. Put students in pairs, A and B. Tell them this mirrors the TOEFL "Take an Interview" task: no preparation time, about 45 seconds per answer.
2. A asks B questions 1–5 on Worksheet 1, then they swap. Keep time and call "switch" every 45 seconds. With a short class, use questions 1, 2 and 5 only.
3. After each answer, the speaker jots down a few key words in the space; the listener notes one strong phrase and one moment of hesitation.
4. Feedback (2 min): ask two or three students for the strongest phrase they heard. Board useful language for later.

Stage 2 — Topic vocabulary (15 min)

1. Students match the 10 words to their definitions alone (5 min). Item 0 (*thrill* — k) is the example.
2. Pairs compare. Check answers, drill pronunciation of *adrenaline* /əˈdrɛnəlɪn/, *exhilarating* /ɪgˈzɪləreɪtɪŋ/, *hazardous* /ˈhæzərdəs/, *endurance* /ɪnˈdʊrəns/ (3 min).
3. Students complete the Part B paragraph with the words from Part A, alone (5 min). *Adrenaline* is used in the example.
4. Quick check (2 min). Point out the clues that decide each gap: *A typical* ___ *will jump* needs a noun (daredevil); *most of these people are not* ___ needs an adjective (reckless).

Stage 3 — Academic lecture (25 min)

1. Pre-listening (2 min): students write two ideas in Part A. Collect two or three guesses.
2. First listening, gist (4 min): play the audio once. Students write the main idea in one sentence (Part B).
3. Note-frame set-up (1 min): read the four "How to take notes" steps aloud and point to the example row so students see the length of a note.
4. Second listening, notes (6 min): play again. Students complete the note frame (Part C).
5. Questions (7 min): students answer the 10 questions in Part D from their notes only. No third listening.
6. Pair check (5 min): partners compare notes and find one point one of them missed. Go through answers with the key, focusing on *why* distractors are wrong.

Stage 4 — Summary + town council debate (25 min)

1. 60-second summary (8 min): 1 minute to plan from notes, then students summarize the lecture to a partner, timed, and swap. If phones are allowed, they record themselves.
2. Debate set-up (3 min): groups of up to six. Read the five "How the debate works" steps and the example pitch opening aloud. Hand out the role cards: five advocates (Rescue team chief, Tourism board, Extreme athlete, Insurance company, Local taxpayer) and one Council Chair. With smaller groups, leave out the Insurance company first, then the Tourism board.
3. Prep (4 min): advocates read their card and prepare a 1-minute pitch. The Chair prepares questions.
4. Debate (8 min): each advocate pitches (1 min), then open discussion. The Chair must pick one policy and justify the decision in 30 seconds.
5. Feedback (2 min): each Chair announces the decision and the deciding reason.

Break (15 min) · Block 2 (60 min)

Stage 5 — Speculating about causes and motives (20 min)

1. Discovery (5 min): students underline the deduction and cause language in the six lecture extracts in Part A.
2. Concept check (3 min): draw a line from 0% to 100% on the board and place *can't have known*, *might have felt* and *must have felt* on it. Ask "Was the professor there in 1979? So how can he say *must*?" (He is deducing from evidence.) Then board the cause phrases and their patterns: *stem from + noun*, *be driven by + noun*, *which explains why + clause*.
3. Controlled practice (7 min): pairs write one speculative sentence for each of the six situations in Part B, using a different structure each time.
4. Build a Sentence (5 min): go through the three "How to build a sentence" steps and the example, then students reorder the five scrambled sentences in Part C, a direct copy of the TOEFL task format. Fastest pair writes answers on the board.

Stage 6 — Academic Discussion post (30 min)

1. Task intro (3 min): read the prompt aloud. Remind students that the TOEFL rewards a new idea, not a repeat of Sofia's or Daniel's post.
2. Timed writing (10 min): strict timer. Minimum 100 words, at least two Worksheet 5 structures and one concession.
3. Peer review (7 min): swap papers. Partners use the checklist and underline every Worksheet 5 structure they find.
4. Class upgrade (10 min): copy two or three anonymous sentences onto the board and improve them together. Then show the model answer from the key.

Stage 7 — Listen and Repeat + homework set-up (10 min)

1. Read the seven sentences in Script C aloud, one at a time (or play them). Students repeat exactly, chorally first, then two or three individuals per sentence (6 min). Sentences get longer, so watch for dropped words and the weak form of *have* in *must have* /ˈmʌstəv/.
2. Homework set-up (4 min): go through the email task on Worksheet 7. Elicit polite request language (*I was wondering if it would be possible to…*) and one reason a charity might matter to someone.

Homework. Worksheet 7, Write an Email (about 120 words).

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Extreme Jobs, Hobbies & Sports · Answer Key

ANSWER KEY

Answers for Worksheets 2, 3, 5 and 6. Worksheets 1, 4 and 7 are open tasks with no fixed answers.

2A VOCABULARY — MATCHING

1. adrenaline — e
2. endurance — b
3. daredevil — d
4. reckless — a
5. calculated risk — f
6. thrive on — h
7. push your limits — i
8. hazardous — c
9. exhilarating — g
10. overcome — j

2B VOCABULARY — PARAGRAPH

1. thrive on
2. daredevil
3. exhilarating
4. endurance
5. push your limits
6. hazardous
7. reckless
8. calculated risk
9. overcome

2 vs 7: "A typical ___ will jump" needs a noun (*daredevil*); "are not ___" needs an adjective (*reckless*). 1 vs 5: "seem to ___ danger" takes an object (*thrive on*).

3B LISTENING — MAIN IDEA (SAMPLE)

Some people crave risk because of sensation seeking, which may be linked to the brain, to how they perceive danger and to the experience of flow; but motives differ, and most risk-takers plan carefully.

3C LISTENING — NOTE FRAME (SAMPLE)

SECTION	CLAIM	EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE
Definition *(example)*	Need for new, varied, intense experiences	Zuckerman, US psychologist, 1960s; high scorers bored easily in routine
Who seeks sensation most	Peaks in late teens / early 20s	Declines slowly with age; may explain higher car insurance for young drivers
Reason 1: the brain	More dopamine in response to novelty	Some studies; evidence still mixed but promising
Reason 2: risk perception	High seekers judge risk as lower	Roller coaster: one friend terrified, one almost bored; less anxiety
Reason 3: flow	Total concentration; challenge = skill	Csikszentmihalyi; time disappears; climbers, surfers, runners
Example 1: bungee jumping	Close to a pure thrill	1979, Oxford Univ. club, Clifton Suspension Bridge, England
Example 2: marathons	Little danger; test of endurance	Runner's high; endocannabinoids may matter more than endorphins
Example 3: firefighters	Real risk, but part of a job; purpose	Slightly above-average sensation seeking; help + team; years of training → calculated risk
Conclusion	Risk-taking is not one single trait	Motives differ; most are careful planners, not reckless

3D LISTENING — QUESTIONS

#	ANS.	TYPE	WHY THE DISTRACTORS ARE WRONG
1	**b**	Main idea	a and d are never discussed; c is only one small part of the lecture.
2	**c**	Detail	He defines it as the need for new, varied and intense experiences; a is the opposite; b and d are not mentioned.
3	**b**	Detail	It tends to peak in the late teens and early twenties, then declines slowly, so c and d are wrong.
4	**d**	Attitude	He says "the evidence here is still mixed, but it's a promising line of research", so a is too strong; b and c are not stated.
5	**a**	Purpose	The ride is identical but the experience is not; he is not warning about danger (b) or explaining adrenaline (d).
6	**c**	Detail	Csikszentmihalyi's flow is total concentration when challenge matches skill; a describes fear, not flow.
7	**d**	Detail	Members of an Oxford University club jumped from the Clifton Suspension Bridge in 1979; New Zealand (a) is not mentioned.
8	**a**	Detail	Researchers used to credit endorphins (b), but recent studies suggest endocannabinoids may play a bigger role.
9	**c**	Inference	The job is driven by a desire to help, which explains why many stay for decades; pay (a) and options (d) are not mentioned, and b contradicts the lecture.
10	**b**	Main idea	Motives differ, and most people who do extreme activities are careful planners, not reckless thrill-seekers. c and d contradict the lecture; a is not discussed.

5A SPECULATING — DISCOVERY

1. *might*; *explain why* (cause)
2. *may*; *lie in* (cause)
3. *seems to*; *stem from* (cause)
4. *must have felt* (almost sure: yes)
5. *can't have known* (almost sure: no)
6. *is driven by*; *which explains why* (cause)

5C BUILD A SENTENCE

1. She must have felt terrified.
2. Their work is driven by a desire to help.
3. They can't have known the danger.
4. Their love of risk may stem from childhood experiences.
5. That's why they stay calm under pressure.

5B SPECULATING — SAMPLE ANSWERS (ACCEPT ANY ACCURATE STRUCTURE)

1. Leo must love pushing his limits. / His hobby is probably driven by a need for challenge.
2. Mia must have been terrified. / She can't have enjoyed the first jump very much.
3. He can't have known that a storm was coming. / He might have underestimated the danger.
4. Their choice is often driven by a desire to help others, which explains why so many apply.
5. This may stem from the way the brain responds to novelty at that age.
6. He might have wanted to prove that age is just a number.

6 **MODEL ACADEMIC DISCUSSION POST (ABOUT 135 WORDS)**

Both Sofia and Daniel make reasonable points, but I think they are missing one group of students: those whose families could never pay for climbing or rafting. For these teenagers, a school trip may be their only chance to push their limits in a safe, supervised setting. Daniel's concern probably comes from cases where trips were badly organized, and that risk is real. However, accidents usually stem from poor planning rather than from the activity itself. If schools hire certified instructors and teach students how to judge a calculated risk, the danger becomes much smaller. In my view, cancelling these trips would not make students safer; it would simply mean that only wealthier teenagers get the chance to overcome their fears and discover what they are capable of.

Why it scores well: a new idea (fair access) instead of simply choosing Sofia or Daniel; four Worksheet 5 structures (*may be, probably comes from, stem from, would*); one concession (*…and that risk is real. However,*); three lesson terms (*push their limits, calculated risk, overcome*).

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Extreme Jobs, Hobbies & Sports · Scripts

TEACHER

Teacher-read scripts. If the audio fails, read Script A aloud at a natural pace; it runs about 4 minutes.

A Lecture: "Why We Crave Risk"

ABOUT 620 WORDS

Professor (male), introductory psychology class.

Okay, let's begin. Picture this: you're standing on a bridge, there's a rope tied around your ankles, and you're about to jump. Some of you are probably thinking, "Never." Others are thinking, "When can I go?" So today's question is: why are some people drawn to danger while others avoid it?

Psychologists call this trait sensation seeking. The idea comes from Marvin Zuckerman, an American psychologist who began studying it in the 1960s. Simply put, sensation seeking is the need for experiences that are new, varied and intense, and the willingness to take risks to get them. Zuckerman found that high scorers on his scale also feel restless in predictable situations. That might explain why some people get bored so easily in a routine job.

Sensation seeking isn't spread evenly across the population. On average, it tends to peak in the late teens and early twenties, and then it declines slowly with age. That may be one reason car insurance costs more for young drivers.

So where does it come from? Part of the answer may lie in the brain. Dopamine is a chemical linked to reward and motivation. Some studies suggest that in high sensation seekers, the brain releases more dopamine in response to something new or exciting. In other words, their interest in danger seems to stem from a stronger response to novelty. I should say the evidence here is still mixed, but it's a promising line of research.

The second piece is how people perceive risk. Imagine two friends on the same roller coaster. One is screaming in terror; the other is almost bored. The ride is identical, but their experience is not. Research shows that high sensation seekers tend to judge risky activities as less dangerous, and they feel less anxiety while doing them.

The third piece is something called flow. The psychologist Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi used this word for a state of total concentration, when the challenge of a task matches your skill. Time seems to disappear. Climbers, surfers and long-distance runners often describe exactly this feeling, and for many of them it's the real reward, not the danger itself.

Let's apply this to three examples. Bungee jumping is close to a pure thrill. The first modern jumps were made in 1979, when members of an Oxford University club leapt from the Clifton Suspension Bridge in England. The first jumpers must have felt terrified as they stepped off the bridge. They can't have known exactly how the ropes would behave.

Marathons are different. The danger is small; the challenge is endurance. Runners often talk about a "runner's high," a feeling of calm and happiness during a long run. Researchers used to credit endorphins, but more recent studies suggest that other chemicals, called endocannabinoids, may play a bigger role.

And firefighters? Here the risk is real, but it's part of a job. Some studies have found that firefighters score slightly above average for sensation seeking. Yet when you ask them, most talk about helping people and about the team. For most firefighters, the job is driven by a desire to help, which explains why many stay in it for decades. And they don't ignore danger: they train for years so that every risk they take is a calculated one.

So, what's the takeaway? Risk-taking is not one single trait. A bungee jumper, a marathon runner and a firefighter may look similar from the outside, but their motives are very different. And, perhaps surprisingly, most people who do extreme activities are careful planners, not reckless thrill-seekers.

For next class, think about the riskiest thing you've ever done. What was really driving you? We'll start there next time.

B Model 60-second summary

ABOUT 120 WORDS

The lecture was about why some people are drawn to risk. The professor explained sensation seeking, Marvin Zuckerman's term for the need for new, varied and intense experiences. It tends to peak in the late teens and early twenties. He gave three possible reasons for it: the brain may release more dopamine in response to novelty, high sensation seekers perceive less risk, and many people enjoy the feeling of flow, when the challenge matches their skill. He then compared bungee jumping, which is close to a pure thrill, marathons, which test endurance, and firefighting, which is driven by a desire to help. He concluded that motives differ, and that most risk-takers plan carefully.

C Listen and Repeat

7 SENTENCES

Read each sentence once at natural speed. Students repeat it exactly.

1. Some people love danger.
2. Her heart was racing at the top.
3. Firefighters take calculated risks every day.
4. Sensation seeking tends to peak in our early twenties.
5. The first jumpers must have felt terrified on the bridge.
6. For most firefighters, the job is driven by a desire to help others.
7. Most people who do extreme sports are careful planners, not reckless thrill-seekers.

♪ Audio

BROWSER TEXT-TO-SPEECH

Play Script A and Script C through the browser's built-in text-to-speech, or read them live.

TRACK	WHERE IT STARTS	LENGTH
Script A, full lecture	"Okay, let's begin."	About 4 min
Script A, second half (the three examples)	"Let's apply this to three examples."	About 1.5 min
Script C, Listen and Repeat	Sentence 1	About 1.5 min with gaps

Settings. Speed 0.95× suits advanced learners and is close to TOEFL lecture pace; raise it to 1.05× for a challenge. Repeat gap 5 seconds; use 7–8 seconds for sentences 6 and 7.

Best voices. In Edge, pick a "Microsoft ... Online (Natural)" US English voice. In Chrome, pick "Google US English". Test the voice on the classroom speakers before the lesson.

In class. Do not pause during the first two listenings in Stage 3, to match test conditions. Backup: in Edge, select Script A and right-click → Read aloud selection, or read it live.